

Weekly Writing - Week 1

Marisa Powers

29 August, 2025

1. How automating tasks through AI like chat GTP changes the way you think and solve problems. How will a deeper conceptual understanding shape our habits and thinking and influence careers that we have with AI in the picture.

Learning R in college has shown me how powerful it can be to let code “do the work.” Automating tasks not only saves time, but it also changes the way I approach problems—rather than getting stuck on repetitive steps, I can focus more on concepts and the big ideas of the material. Tools like ChatGPT have enhanced this process even further. I see them as extremely helpful aids, as long as I take the time to actually understand what the code is doing. The real value comes from troubleshooting with these tools and using them to fill in learning gaps.

In fact, I think the presence of AI in education is already reshaping how professors teach. Since students can rely on ChatGPT for step-by-step clarification, instructors may not need to spend as much class time breaking down the smallest details. This creates room to cover more material at a faster pace. Given this course content could start advancing and becoming more challenging to keep students engaged and ensure that learning stays rigorous. Personally, I know I wouldn’t have learned as much as I have without being able to quickly check my work and explore new concepts using AI.

Looking toward the workforce, I believe AI will bring major shifts over the next decade. Those who know how to use and implement AI effectively will stand out since they’ll be able to streamline tasks, increase efficiency, and take on higher-level work. At the same time, AI will help reduce overload by handling routine processes but there will still be a critical need for people to review and provide quality control over its outputs. I don’t think AI will completely eliminate jobs as there will always be errors from what the AI work produced. Employees who are skilled and savvy with AI will likely be recognized and valued more highly in their careers since they can leverage these tools to push productivity and innovation further.